

FOR FIRST-TIME INVESTORS



The First-Time Investor Starter Pack

Four corridors.

Four cities.

Thirty-nine days that reshape a decade.

4

PRIORITY
CITIES

39

DAYS OF
TOURNAMENT

31

MATCHES IN THESE
FOUR CITIES

3

INVESTMENT
WINDOWS

A field guide to US World Cup host city real estate, compiled from public-record real estate databases, municipal authorities, and tournament filings. Every claim verifiable. Every source named.

PREAMBLE

A note before you start.

Most of the money that will be made from the World Cup has already been made.

The investors who saw it coming bought in 2022, 2023, 2024. They bought when EaDo was still a parking lot. When the Atlanta BeltLine was 30% complete. When Allapattah was still called "the next Wynwood" by people nobody listened to. By the time the tournament kicks off on June 11, the early money has already finished its first cycle.

This pack is not for them. This pack is for the investor who is reading about World Cup real estate for the first time and wondering if they have missed the window.

The honest answer is: **you have missed the cheapest window. You have not missed the window.**



Figure 1. The three investment windows around the FIFA World Cup 2026 catalyst.

There are three windows in any catalyst event like the World Cup. The first window is the years before, when the corridor is still mispriced. That window is closed.

The second window is the tournament itself. June 11 to July 19. Thirty-nine days. The money here is short-term: rental income, parking, hospitality, retail. It is real, it is significant, and it is mostly captured by people who already own the assets. A few specific plays remain available to new entrants in this window.

The third window is the twelve to thirty-six months after the tournament. This is where most of the durable money will be made by first-time investors. The corridors that get the most exposure during the World Cup will go through a price correction in late 2026, and the smart entries happen during that correction, not during the tournament hype.

Read with one question in mind.

Where would I buy, and over what hold period, if I wanted to act on what the data is showing rather than on what the headlines say?

CONTEXT

The financing environment you are entering.

Before any corridor analysis, the cost of capital determines what is possible. As of May 2026, here is what financing looks like for first-time investors.

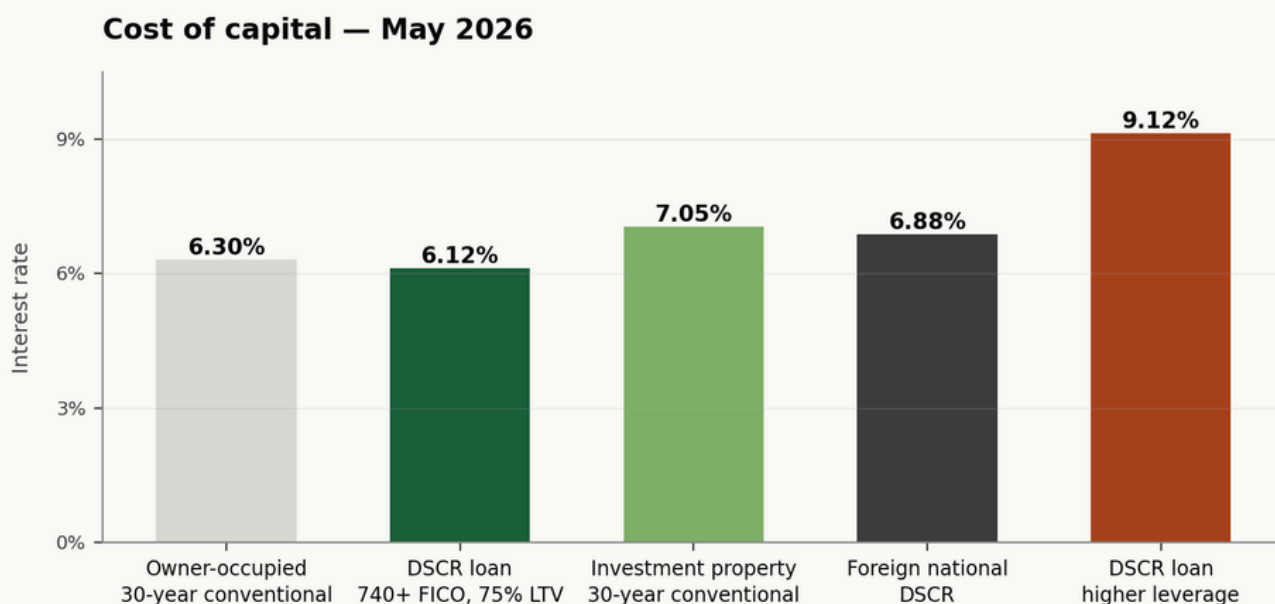


Figure 2. Investment property financing rates by loan product, May 2026. Sources: Freddie Mac PMMS, Bankrate, HomeAbroad, Defy Mortgage.

What this means in practice.

For a first-time investor with a \$400,000 target property, expect to bring \$80,000–\$100,000 in down payment plus three to six months of PITIA in liquid reserves. A 0.5–1.5% rate premium over owner-occupied financing is the baseline cost of investment property capital in 2026.

Why this matters for the World Cup play.

Short-term rental cash flow during the tournament can carry a property through several months of mortgage payments in some corridors. But cash flow alone is not the entry point. Appreciation in the third window is. **Do not underwrite a deal on tournament-only income.**

Capital requirements at a glance

Down payment, conventional investment property	20–25%
Down payment, DSCR loan (standard tier)	25%
Down payment, DSCR loan (higher leverage or lower credit)	25–30%
Liquid reserves required	3–6 months PITIA
Minimum credit score, best DSCR pricing	740+
Minimum credit score, conventional investment	640–660
Foreign national DSCR — US credit history required?	No

THE LANDSCAPE

The 16 host cities. The 4 we focus on.

The 2026 FIFA World Cup will be played across 16 host cities in the US, Canada, and Mexico, with 104 matches over 39 days. This pack focuses on the four US host cities with the most direct real estate catalyst: Houston, Atlanta, Dallas, and Miami. Together, these four cities host 31 matches, more than half the US tournament load.

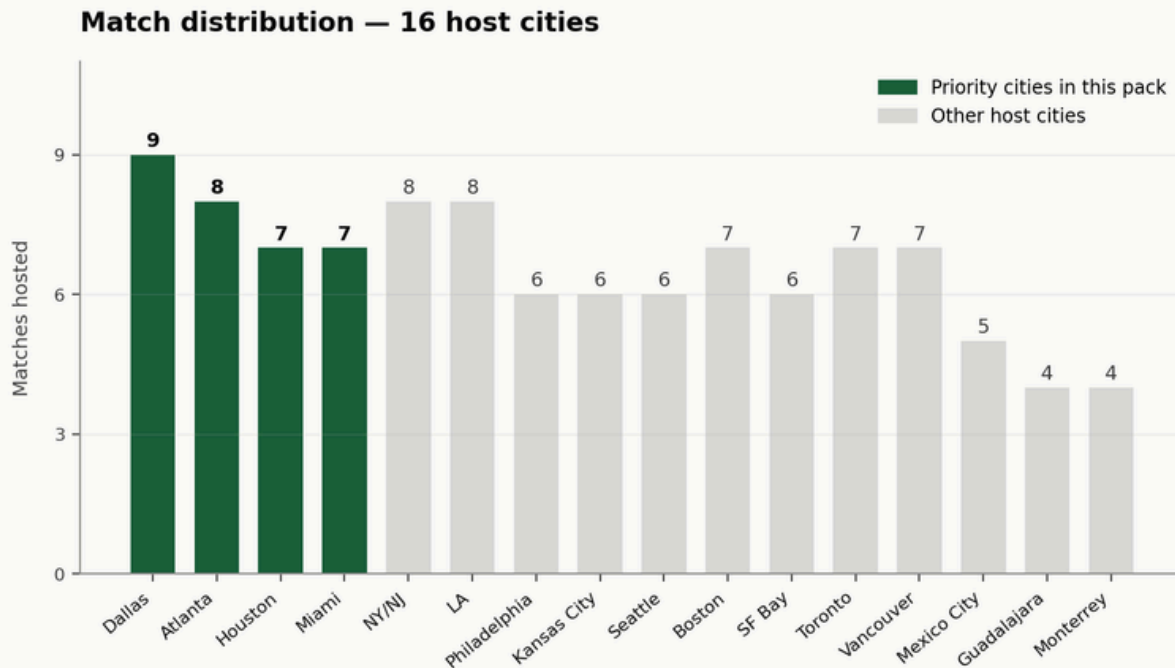


Figure 3. World Cup match distribution across the 16 host cities. Dallas hosts more matches than any other US city. Source: FIFA, Al Jazeera, MLSSoccer.

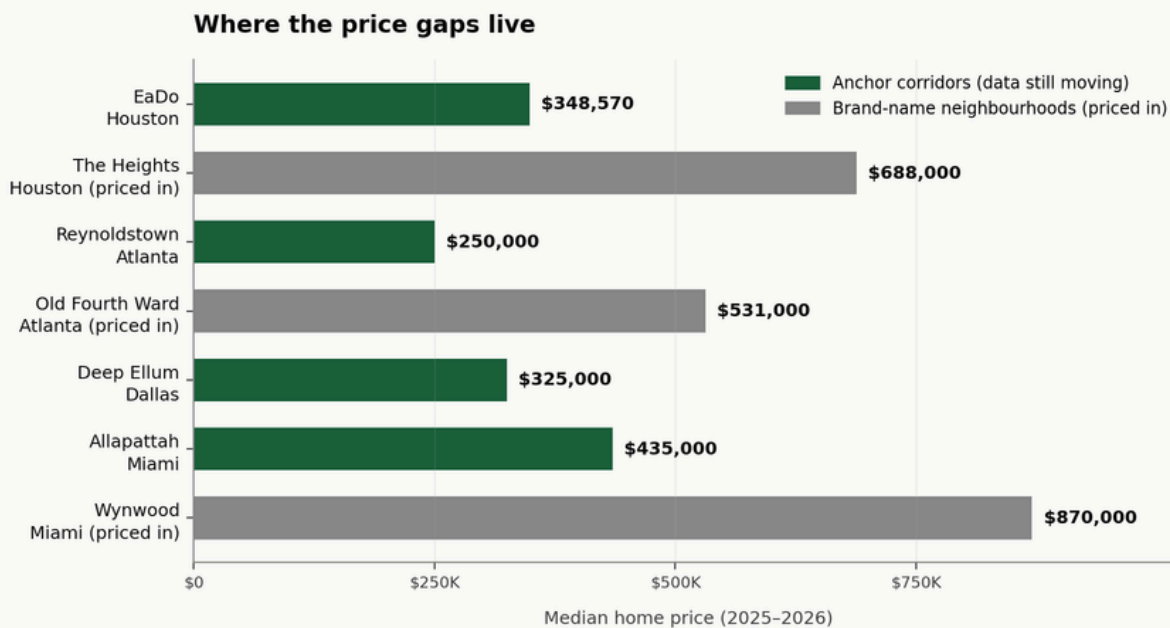


Figure 4. Median home prices, anchor corridors vs brand-name neighbourhoods. Sources: Redfin, Movoto, Zillow (2025-2026 data).

CORRIDOR 1

Houston: EaDo (East Downtown).

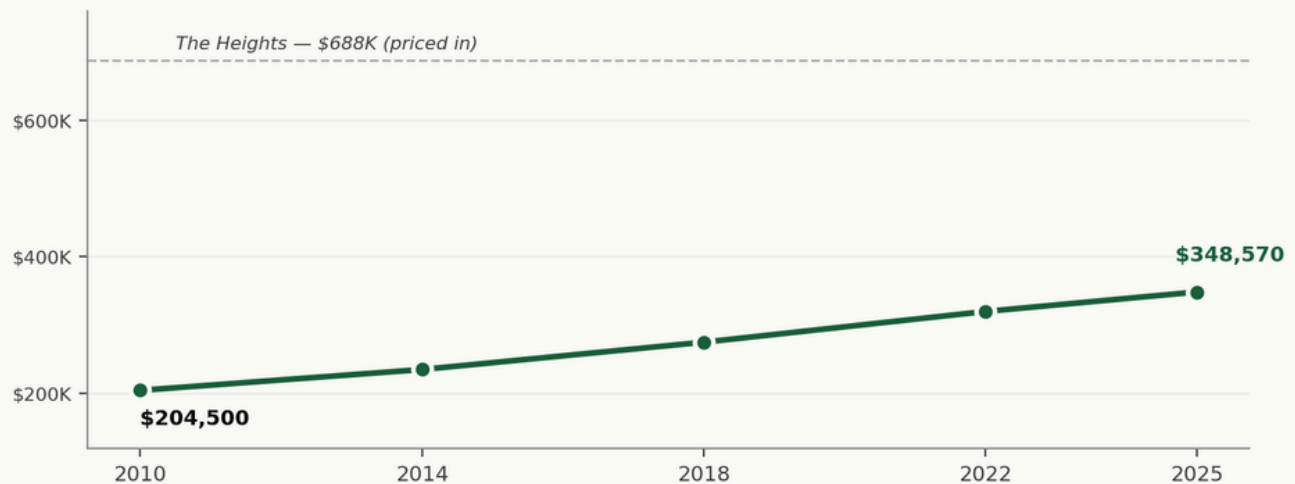
\$348KEaDo MEDIAN
HOME PRICE**\$250M+**TOTAL CORRIDOR
INVESTMENT**7**MATCHES AT
NRG STADIUM**Inside**FAN FESTIVAL
LOCATION**EaDo median home price — 15-year trajectory**

Figure 5. EaDo median home price, 2010–2025. The Heights reference line shows where the corridor is heading. Source: Houston Properties Team, East Downtown Management District.

The data

EaDo's median home price sits at roughly half The Heights (\$688,000) and Montrose (\$580,000–\$785,000). The price gap reflects timing, not fundamentals. The METRORail already runs through it. Walking distance to Minute Maid Park, the Toyota Center, and BBVA Stadium.

East River, a 150-acre mixed-use development on Buffalo Bayou, opened with 360 apartments, office, retail, and a nine-hole golf course. Phase 1 of East Blocks, a 10-block adaptive reuse project, breaks ground this year, completing August 2026 — six weeks after the World Cup final.

Houston hosts seven matches at NRG Stadium across June 14 to July 4, including a Round of 32 game (June 30) and a Round of 16 game (July 4). The July 4 match coincides with a US Semiquincentennial ceremony at NRG. The FIFA Fan Festival lands inside the corridor for the full 39-day tournament.

CORRIDOR 1 — HOUSTON · CONTINUED

Houston match schedule at NRG Stadium

Date	Match	Stage
June 14	Germany vs Curaçao	Group E
June 17	Portugal vs DR Congo	Group K
June 20	Netherlands vs Sweden	Group F
June 23	Portugal vs Uzbekistan	Group K
June 27	Group stage match	Group A
June 30	Round of 32	Knockout
July 4	Round of 16 + Semiquincentennial	Knockout

Three top-10 teams (Germany, Netherlands, Portugal) play in Houston during the group stage. Cristiano Ronaldo plays at least two matches at NRG.

Short-term rental rules you must know

Houston Ordinance 2025-322 took effect January 1, 2026. As of April 1, 2026, Airbnb and VRBO are removing unregistered listings. The rules are clear, the fees are modest, but you must register before listing.

Annual registration fee - **\$275 + \$33.10 admin**

Owner-occupied required? - **No**

Liability insurance minimum - **\$1,000,000**

Occupancy cap - **2 per bedroom + 2 extra**

Hotel occupancy tax - **13% (6% state + 7% city)**

Fines for non-registration - **\$100–\$500 per day**

30+ day stays exempt - **Yes**

The adjacent corridor: Spring Branch.

Average one-bedroom rent of \$1,400, the lowest among inner-loop-adjacent areas. Active redevelopment. The rental yield math works here in a way it does not in Montrose.

Risk flag.

Houston's overall market has been flat for two years. EaDo's appreciation curve is corridor-specific, not citywide. Hurricane exposure is material. Flood insurance is a fixed cost most first-time investors underweight.

CORRIDOR 2

Atlanta: Reynoldstown and the BeltLine Southwest.

\$250K

REYNOLDSTOWN
ENTRY

25%

YoY VALUE
GROWTH

8

MATCHES INCL.
SEMIFINAL

\$242M

FY26 BELTLINE
BUDGET

The data

Atlanta Beltline, Inc. passed a \$242 million FY26 budget. Allocations: \$98.8M for trail design and construction, \$40.6M for affordable housing, \$56.3M for real estate acquisitions. Trail completion is moving from 30% to ~85% by end of FY26.

Reynoldstown offers the most affordable entry point to BeltLine living, with homes starting around \$250,000 in 2025 and ~25% YoY property value growth. The Old Fourth Ward, a few stops east on the trail, has a median home price of \$531,000 (up 56.1% YoY per Redfin, September 2025) — already priced in.

Atlanta hosts eight matches at Mercedes-Benz Stadium, including a semifinal on July 15. Over 520,000 spectators are projected. The tournament is expected to contribute \$503.2 million to Georgia's economy.

Atlanta match schedule at Mercedes-Benz Stadium

Date	Match	Stage
June 15	Spain vs Cape Verde	Group H
June 18	Czechia vs South Africa	Group A
June 21	Spain vs Saudi Arabia	Group H
June 24	Morocco vs Haiti	Group C
June 27	DR Congo vs Uzbekistan	Group K
July 1	Round of 32	Knockout
July 7	Round of 16	Knockout
July 15	Semifinal	Knockout

CORRIDOR 2 — ATLANTA · CONTINUED

Short-term rental rules you must know

Atlanta's STR ordinance has been in force since March 2022. The rules are notably host-friendly compared to most major US cities — except for one provision that disqualifies most out-of-state buyers entirely.

Annual STR license fee	\$150
Notarized affidavit required	Yes (~\$15–25)
Maximum licenses per owner	2
Owner residency requirement	Atlanta resident required
Total tax burden	~21% (8% city + 5% county + 8% state)
Average host gross revenue (AirDNA 2026)	\$30,539/year
Projected nightly rate, World Cup	\$285 (from \$150 baseline)

The Atlanta residency trap.

If you do not already live in Atlanta, you cannot directly operate a short-term rental inside city limits. Options: partner with a local primary resident, target BeltLine corridors outside Atlanta city limits, or focus on long-term rental and appreciation play.

The adjacent corridor: West End.

Lower price point than West Midtown and Old Fourth Ward. Small breweries, coworking spaces, historic charm. The Southside BeltLine Trail finishes near it, completing the 22-mile loop.

Climate and risk

Atlanta's overall market is in soft correction. Metro median sale price slipped to ~\$380,000 in February 2025 (-10.6% YoY per MLS data). Reynoldstown and Old Fourth Ward are pulling against the citywide trend. Multi-family permitting has slowed; deliveries dip in 2026, which may push rental vacancy back toward 5% by late 2025.

CORRIDOR 3

Dallas: Fair Park and South Dallas.

9MATCHES —
MOST IN US**277**FAIR PARK
ACRES**35K**FAN FEST
CAPACITY**2,000+**MEDIA PROS
DOWNTOWN**The data**

Dallas hosts nine matches at AT&T Stadium (branded "Dallas Stadium" for the tournament), including a semifinal on July 14. This is more matches than any other US host city. The FIFA Fan Festival is centered at Fair Park, a 277-acre complex hosting up to 35,000 people at once. The DART Green Line connects Fair Park directly to downtown.

South Dallas around Fair Park is undergoing direct repricing pressure. New construction is targeting "potential instant equity" against the World Cup catalyst. Three-bedroom homes a few blocks from Fair Park are listing in the high \$200,000s while comparable units in the area trade above \$300,000. The Mill City neighbourhood, minutes from Fair Park, is a current example of this dispersion.

The Kay Bailey Hutchison Convention Center in Downtown Dallas hosts the International Broadcast Center. Roughly 2,000 to 5,000 media professionals will base in Downtown Dallas. The Cedars, immediately south of the convention center, is the closest emerging corridor.

Dallas match schedule at AT&T; Stadium

Date	Match	Stage
June 14	Netherlands vs Japan	Group F
June 17	England vs Croatia	Group L
June 22	Argentina vs Austria	Group J
June 25	Japan vs Sweden	Group F
June 27	Jordan vs Argentina	Group J
June 30	Round of 32	Knockout
July 3	Round of 32	Knockout
July 6	Round of 16	Knockout
July 14	Semifinal	Knockout

CORRIDOR 3 — DALLAS · CONTINUED

Short-term rental rules — and the legal limbo

Dallas regulation is in active legal limbo. The city passed an ordinance in June 2023 to ban roughly 90% of STRs (those in single-family zones). The Dallas Short-Term Rental Alliance sued. A temporary injunction (December 6, 2023) blocked enforcement. The appeals court upheld the injunction in February 2025, and again in July 2025.

In **October 2025, the City of Dallas asked the Supreme Court of Texas to intervene, specifically to enforce the ban before the World Cup.** As of May 2026, the ban is not enforced, but the legal status could shift on short notice.

Current registration	MUNIREvs portal (required)
Occupancy cap	3 per bedroom, 12 per unit max
Total tax burden	15% (6% state + 9% city)
STR ban status	Blocked by injunction (as of May 2026)
Pending case	Supreme Court of Texas review requested
Fair Park parking license fee (residents)	\$100/year
Reported parking rates during tournament	Up to \$250 per spot

Dallas is the highest-uncertainty STR jurisdiction.

If you are buying with STR cash flow as the primary thesis, this is the riskiest of the four cities. If you are buying for long-term appreciation around the Fair Park corridor or the broadcast hub, the legal status of STRs is secondary.

The adjacent corridor: Deep Ellum.

Median home value \$325,000. Median rent \$1,740. Walk Score 98, among the highest in any Dallas neighbourhood. Homeownership rate 11%, signalling a strong rental market. The historic jazz district immediately east of downtown.

Climate and risk

DFW housing inventory expanded 22% YoY in August 2025; supply has tipped into a buyer's market. Some forecasts anticipate a further -2 to -3% price movement over 12 months. This is the entry-point window for patient investors.

CORRIDOR 4

Miami: Allapattah.

\$435K

ALLAPATTAH
MEDIAN

-14.9%

YoY (ENTRY
WINDOW)

67%

LITTLE HAITI
5-YR

7

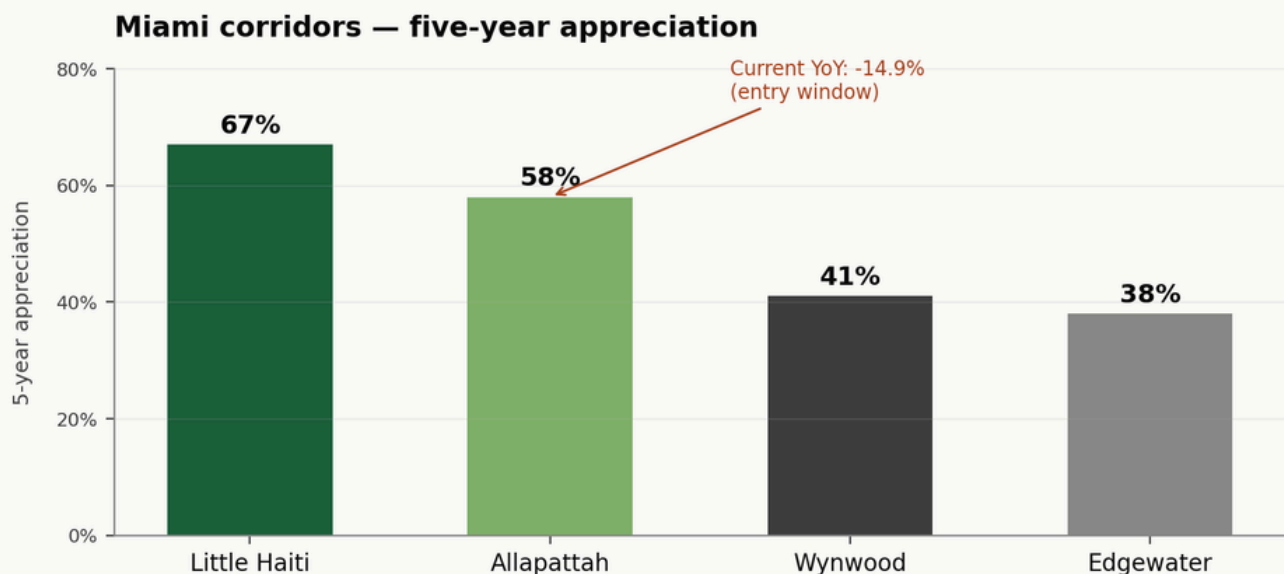
MATCHES AT
HARD ROCK

Figure 6. Five-year appreciation across Miami corridors. Allapattah's current YoY correction is the third-window entry signal. Sources: Redfin, NeighborhoodScout, Million Luxury market data.

The data

Allapattah carries the "next Wynwood" label from multiple developers and market analysts. Land that sold at \$20 per square foot now trades at \$130. Median home price sits at \$435,000 against Wynwood pricing, roughly half. Critical caveat: the market is in a price correction year, with Allapattah median sale prices down 14.9% YoY (Redfin, December 2025). **This is the entry-point window dispersion creates — exactly the third-window play described in the preamble.**

Little Haiti, immediately adjacent, leads Miami with ~67% five-year appreciation. Allapattah and Little Haiti combined rose roughly 166% between 2010 and 2015 — the largest sustained appreciation cycle of any Miami corridor outside the bayfront. Major projects in Allapattah include No. 17 Residences (192-unit apartment), gallery openings, and a Bjarke Ingels-designed mixed-use development in the pipeline.

CORRIDOR 4 — MIAMI · CONTINUED

The three-layer regulatory stack

Miami operates a regulatory stack that is more complex than any other US World Cup host city. Three separate jurisdictions, each with its own licensing requirements. Property zoning determines everything.

Layer 1 — State of Florida (DBPR)

All STRs require a state Vacation Rental Dwelling License.

Layer 2 — Miami-Dade County

Certificate of Use required. Tax registrations apply. Fines up to \$20,000 per violation.

Layer 3 — City of Miami zoning (Miami 21 Transect Zones)

T4, T5, T6, and CI-HD zones generally permit STRs. T3 (low-density residential) zones largely prohibit them. Allapattah and Wynwood sit primarily in zones that permit STRs in commercial and mixed-use buildings. Property needs a Business Tax Receipt and must comply with HOA/condo declarations.

Miami Beach is a separate jurisdiction.

STRs banned in single-family neighborhoods. Fines start at \$20,000 and scale to \$100,000. Restricted to South Beach Entertainment District, North Beach Town Center, and specific high-density zones. Do not buy in Miami Beach for STR cash flow without verifying zone and building eligibility.

Realistic income expectations

AirDNA average daily rate, Brickell luxury (Q1 2026)	\$287
Average occupancy, Brickell luxury (annual)	68%
Winter premium above annual average	+30-50%
Summer occupancy floor	Below 55%
Net annual STR income, after costs	\$35,000-60,000
Net annual long-term lease income	\$42,000-54,000

The gap between STR and long-term lease net income is smaller than first-time investors expect, once management fees, furnishing, insurance, and seasonal occupancy swings are factored in.

Climate risk.

Allapattah carries a 73% severe flood risk over 30 years per First Street data. 100% of properties at extreme wind risk over 30 years. Insurance can run 20-40% higher than standard. Florida insurance markets are in active stress.

SIDE BY SIDE

The four cities compared.

Each of the four corridors carries a distinct regulatory and return profile. The heatmap below scores each city across the five dimensions that determine whether a deal is viable for a first-time investor.

Short-term rental regulatory environment



Figure 7. Short-term rental regulatory environment across the four priority cities. Sources: City of Houston (Ordinance 2025-322), City of Atlanta (Ordinance 20-O-1656), City of Dallas Planning & Development, City of Miami (Miami 21 zoning portal).



Figure 8. Corridor positioning by return potential and complexity of execution. Anchor corridors (green) carry higher return potential but require more careful underwriting. Brand-name neighbourhoods (grey) are shown for reference; they remain stable holds but the appreciation has already happened.

WHAT TO TAKE AWAY

Four patterns. Portable across cities.

After mapping all four cities, four patterns repeat. These are the mental models to carry forward, regardless of which city you eventually choose.

One. The famous neighbourhood is rarely the best buy.

The Heights, Wynwood, Old Fourth Ward, Bishop Arts. All proven. All priced in. The smart money is one corridor over.

Two. Infrastructure projects locals talk about are the ones worth following.

The BeltLine in Atlanta. East River and East Blocks in Houston. DART in Dallas. The Allapattah industrial conversions in Miami. Long-term capital follows long-term infrastructure.

Three. "The next [famous neighbourhood]" is a phrase to take seriously.

When locals and developers start using it, the data is usually already moving. Allapattah was called "the next Wynwood" five years ago. The people calling it that were right.

Four. The World Cup is a corridor-level story, not a city-level one.

Each host city has one or two corridors that will absorb most of the tournament-driven attention. The investors who know which corridors will move twice. Once on tournament hype. Once when the data settles.

When to enter

During the tournament (June 11 to July 19, 2026)

Short-term rental plays in existing inventory. Limited window for new entrants.

Late 2026 to mid-2027

Every host city historically corrects 3-8% in the three to six months after a major sporting catalyst. The cleanest entry window for first-time investors.

2027 to 2028

Structural appreciation as infrastructure investments deliver. Hold periods of 24-36 months are realistic.

BEFORE YOU MAKE AN OFFER

The first-time investor checklist.

Before you make an offer in any of these corridors, work through this list. Each item is non-negotiable — they are the difference between a deal that closes and a deal that traps capital.

Financing

- Pre-approved with at least one DSCR or conventional investment property lender
- 20–30% down payment plus closing costs in liquid form
- Three to six months of PITIA in reserves
- Credit score reviewed; if below 700, consider waiting 90 days to improve

Property-level due diligence

- Verified the property's specific zoning (especially in Miami's T-zone system)
- Confirmed the property is registrable as an STR in its jurisdiction
- Reviewed HOA and condo declarations for STR restrictions
- Pulled the most recent local MLS comparables — not just neighbourhood averages
- Underwritten the deal at conservative cash flow assumptions, not peak tournament rates

Risk underwriting

- Flood insurance quote in hand for any Miami or Houston property
- Hurricane and wind exposure factored into reserve requirements
- Tax burden calculated correctly (STR taxes range 13–21% across the four cities)
- STR regulatory status verified as of date of purchase, not date of pack

Hold period

- Two to three years for World Cup catalyst plays
- Five or more years for structural appreciation plays
- Exit strategy identified before close

DISCLOSURE

What this pack is not.

This pack is not a guarantee of returns. Real estate is local, illiquid, and exposed to interest rates, insurance markets, climate risk, and policy shifts. Allapattah is in a 14.9% YoY price correction. Dallas inventory has expanded over 22% YoY. Houston's overall market has been flat for two years. Atlanta is in a soft correction.

What this pack is: a verified, sourced field guide to where the data is moving in the four cities most directly exposed to the FIFA World Cup 2026 catalyst. The numbers here are publicly available. The pattern they form is what most first-time investors will not connect until after it is too late to act on cheaply.

Sources

All data verified between September 2025 and May 2026 from the following sources:

Real estate data: Redfin, Movoto, Zillow, NeighborhoodScout, AirDNA, Houston Properties Team, East Downtown Management District, Atlanta Beltline, Inc., Million Luxury, BLDUP. **Financing:** Freddie Mac PMMS (April 30, 2026), Bankrate, HomeAbroad, Defy Mortgage, Ridge Street Capital, Sistar Mortgage. **Municipal authorities:** City of Houston Administration & Regulatory Affairs Department (Ordinance 2025-322), City of Atlanta Department of City Planning (Ordinance 20-O-1656), City of Dallas Planning & Development Department, City of Miami (Miami 21 zoning portal), Miami-Dade County. **Tournament data:** FIFA, NYNJ FIFA World Cup 2026 host committee, MLSsoccer.com, Al Jazeera Sport, Colliers ("From Stadiums to Skylines" metro report), Roadtrips, Atlanta Beltline World Cup 26 reporting. **News and analysis:** NBC 5 Dallas-Fort Worth, FOX 5 Atlanta, WFAA, Rough Draft Atlanta, Capital B News, Dallas Observer, Travel Noire, FIP Commercial, Buffalo Bayou Partnership, JMK Property Management, Atlanta Guide. **Climate risk:** First Street Foundation.

NEXT

The windows that are still open.

The first window closed before most readers of this pack ever heard the phrase "World Cup real estate."

The second window opens June 11.

The third window opens late 2026.

Both are still open. Neither will stay that way.

If you want to discuss your entry into either of the open windows, reply to the post you found this pack in with the word "Corridor"

Shoot me a DM or

Mail me at .

— *Akin*